

PREPARE FOR THE
CROSSFIT®
OPEN

1

Plan It Out!

The CrossFit Open starts in roughly 3 months. Upon the go live date for this guide there were 84 days. Now there are even FEWER!

Let's get one thing straight, the Open is a competition. This is not just for participation anymore. These are tests and you need to be ready.

NOT planning for yourself or your athletes will result in unfulfilled people come mid April.

Before you do anything, write down how many days you are away from competition and ensure that you are ACTUALLY preparing smartly for game day(s).

When this is left until February 1, the "oh shit" happens and training rapidly becomes tiring and mentally stressful because you are physically un-prepared.

2

Know Your Athletes

Do you know how long it takes to peak and get into the "best state" possible for the open? Do you know how much the HARDER training drops their 1RM's in all of the major lifts? Do you or your athletes rely on hope and magic for the opens each year? How long have you or your athletes been training?

All of these questions are important ones that we have helped thousands of clients with since 2008.

it is KEY that you know how you respond to changes in training, changes in styles and changes in parts of the season.

For example, did you know that when you start doing open STYLE training (for 3+ weeks) that "most" athletes lose 5-10% of absolute strength 1RM in that time period?

Are you under the fantasy impression that everything in fitness gets better all at the same time?

Training age, experience, adaptation and a few other things have major parts to play on how YOU respond.

3

Practice Makes Perfect

The season of the OPENS contains 2 tough workouts per week for 40 days. This is a 40 days season, NOT a 3 day competition. It is COMPLETELY different than the regionals peak and prep. It is fairly easy to survive for a few days, but for 40 days, it catches up!

Preparation is different.

It is REALLY important to train phases that resemble the Open within the prep season with your athletes. Knowing how well your athlete responds to the demands of the open is key. These keys can be picked up in what we call "packaged" weeks in the season. These weeks have been specifically designed to resemble the mental and physical challenges associated with preparation and implementation of the opens workouts.

This can be done through online tests, local competitions, in house monitoring, etc...The point is the watch and see how people respond to these specific tests and challenges.

Sleep disruption, dehydration issues, low fueling with lowered digestibility?... what happens in this time? When you know, you can improve and fix it.

4

Its The Open!

The Opens have run for a while now. and there have been MANY iterations of movements and combinations of movements within the years of competition.

Review and get to know all the movements, standards AND practice knowing all of these.

Did you know that the average time for Open workouts completed by the top 100 people over the last 5 years has been 11:23.
...and only 1 time in the past 5 years has there been a score of a max lift.

If there have been 25 plus tests at 11 min on average and ONLY 4% of the time this score has been a max lift, what has your training been?

Have you been losing on your muscle endurance and aerobic capacity chasing the 4%?

Is it possible (take a breath now) that you can get absolutely weaker to get better in the OPENS? GASP!

4

Its The Open! (Cont.)

We know the Open contain certain time frames and certain movements. Train these appropriately to make them as AEROBIC as possible.

YES, make weight training and muscle endurance aerobic.

The goal over a season is to do this for people to ensure they can maintain strength and strength endurance together as high as possible.

Are you doing the opens once or twice per week? in most cases 60% of all 250,000 participants do the workout twice OR MORE!

If this is the case, how many weekly training sessions have you done with 100 toes to bar in a workout under fatigue with another barbell movement? You need to spend time hitting these movements with the volume needed to succeed in the Opens

If this number scares you, you are simply participating in the opens and not competing in them.

If you perform the opens workout twice, you have the same movements and reps TWICE!...so train that way to prepare, otherwise you are guessing.

5

3...2...1...

STOP!

Plan Of Attack

3 months out: Focus on finishing up major off season structural fixes and large scale skills with high CNS demand.

Time to start a shift into beginning the build to higher tempo work that resembles perfecting a 3-4 min interval time frame of threshold and max power work by 1 month out, along with perfectly keeping and maintaining as much prerequisite strength required for the Open.

Implement fatigue based gymnastics, pacing practice in aerobic work with muscle endurance, while still hitting residual effects of accumulation in the training in the design.

The CNS is king, monitor recovery, practice and see how well individuals recover from intense efforts. Rest is good.....

2 months out: focus on figuring out the limitations involved in power output and performance. at this time the "shitty shit shit" (burning zone) time frame occurs as we call it at OPEX and the build is in place or is beginning for the highest PRACTICE of tempo and threshold work for the year

1 month out: focus on refining, planning the attack and "fine tuning" all things OPENs style. for some this might take 3 weeks, for others it might take 1 week. This is based on fast adaptation and training age as discussed previously. When "tuned", maintain with touches in all areas without fatiguing the system, then get ready to rock.

The smarter and better you prepare, the happier you will be after 5 Open weeks.